

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠ 2

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥ 4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦ 10

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥ 4

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥ Q

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ J 10 9 5
♦ 8 7 3 2
♣ 7 5 2

♠ A 9 7 6
♥ A Q 4
♦ A J 4
♣ Q 10 8



♠ K J 5 2
♥ 8 6 3
♦ K 10 9
♣ A 6 4

♠ 10 8 4
♥ K 7 2
♦ Q 6 5
♣ K J 9 3

With 9 points SOUTH is unable to decide the final contract. If NORTH has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If NORTH opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So SOUTH makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells NORTH that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal NORTH has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 2			

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ 10 8 4

♣ 8 7 4

♠ 8 5 3

♥ J 10

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ A J 6 2



♠ A 10 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J 2

♣ K 10 9 5

♠ J 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ Q 3

This time EAST has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

WEST has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

EAST, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1NT

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♥4

Board 3

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q
♦ K 10 9 8 6
♣ A Q 10 4

♠ J 7 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 4 2
♣ 9 8 7 3



♠ 10 5 3
♥ K 9 7 6 4 2
♦ 7 5 3
♣ 6

♠ K Q 6
♥ A J 10 3
♦ A Q
♣ K J 5 2

SOUTH has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 2 points to SOUTH's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

West	North	East	South
			2NT
All Pass			
2NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 10			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 10 8
 ♥ A 10 9
 ♦ K Q 10 8
 ♣ K 9 7

♠ 6 5 4

♥ K 6 5 4 3

♦ A 7

♣ A 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 10 8

♠ Q J 9 2

♥ J 8

♦ 6 5 3 2

♣ 6 4 2

WEST has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

EAST has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking WEST to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But WEST has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			Pass
1NT	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7 3
♥ 10 9 8 6 2
♦ A 7
♣ 5 4 2

♠ K Q J
♥ A 4
♦ K Q 10 8
♣ A J 7 3



♠ A 5 4
♥ Q J 3
♦ J 6 3 2
♣ 10 9 8

♠ 10 9 6 2
♥ K 7 5
♦ 9 5 4
♣ K Q 6

NORTH has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

SOUTH has 8 points. She adds NORTH's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and NORTH passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q